

Staff Meeting, School Logistics

Date: Wednesday, 9 September 2026

Institution: Dar Al-Ulum Montreal

Chair: Mufti Mirza-Zain Baig, Principal

Present: Principal and teaching staff (four teachers spoke on record, speakers not named in the transcript)

Source: Audio transcript, bilingual (French and English)

1. Projector and classroom equipment

A teacher reported that the projector in the meeting room keeps failing. The lamp light flashes red and the unit shuts off mid-day as if there is no input, which has happened about three times. Another teacher avoids the problem by using a personal HDMI cable. The Principal noted that on several evenings the projector was left running overnight, which overheats the lamp, and asked everyone to make sure it is shut off every night. It was suggested that someone has changed the projector settings. The Principal has not checked the settings yet and will do so.

A teacher recommended large touchscreen LCD panels as a future replacement for projectors, having used them at a university in Turkey. The Principal asked for links and will look into it as a longer term upgrade.

2. Portal and curriculum adjustments for 2026-2027

The Principal outlined the changes made to the portal, mainly in science and mathematics.

In Science Secondary 3, there is a lot of material and from a certain point in the year the students will work exclusively in the portal. All videos and explanations are there, the teacher's role is to present them and reinforce. Science Secondary 4 has few changes. In Mathematics Secondary 3 and 5, one or two units were added on proportions and rates, one placed in October and one at the end of the year. The year is more organized than last year.

In French Secondary 3, the novel Rouh was removed. Only Oscar remains, with Les Vertiges at the end of the year. In English Secondary 3, two manuals were removed and the only novel is The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe, so students carry one novel instead of three. English otherwise is unchanged. In French and English Secondary 2 the manual is used throughout, with one short unit on the history of the Franks (about four hours) added at the end of the year.

The full plan will be sent this week. It lists week by week what to work on and whether each item is exclusively in the portal or also in the manual. The portal itself is going through an ownership change (about 30 percent academy, 30 percent company) so the Principal is making as many adjustments as possible now to avoid disruption. Student schedules are being finalized and will follow.

3. Workbooks, exercises and evaluations

The Principal will hand out the regular workbooks today so teachers can begin. A teacher offered to print the first unit evaluations, the Principal already has them.

Students complete the exercises in the workbook. For the supplementary exercises in the binder, teachers should try to complete most of them but may use their judgment and cut where a chapter is too long, especially in French, and simply note what was done and what was not. Evaluations and tests are not to be cut.

Scanning of student work is split by group: one group scans on Monday, the other on Tuesday.

4. Printing and supplies

Teachers are not required to print material themselves. Printed packages are only needed for Secondary 3, 4 and 5 (the groups that attend once a month), and these will be printed at the school. The last printer cartridge was installed at the start of the semester and there are no spares on hand. The Principal has bought more ink and will bring it in.

5. Manual collection, Thursday 10 September

At the end of the day tomorrow, teachers collect the students' manuals for language of instruction (ELA and Français langue d'enseignement) and mathematics, and leave them in the office. This applies only to Thursday classes: Grade 3 and 4 ELA, Grade 5 ELA, Grade 6 ELA, Grade 8 ELA (ELA only, not ESL), French language of instruction, and mathematics for Grade 4 and 6. The Principal will return the manuals to teachers Friday morning.

6. Students with difficulties

On the 25th, teachers will be asked to flag students with learning difficulties. The information and forms will be sent to staff this week so there is time to prepare.

7. Dismissal and supervision

Teachers go down and come back up with their group. At the end of the day, stay with your group and help with dismissal until at least 16:00. Having one person outside and one inside is too much work for two people, so a rotation will run once or twice a week where one staff member stays inside until 16:15 and the others help with departures.

8. Teacher workspace

A teacher asked for a dedicated work space or staff office for teachers who are on break or need to work outside their class hours when all rooms are occupied. The Principal agreed the side room needs to be rearranged and will try to set up at least a corner for staff. Upstairs was preferred over the basement as the quieter area, though classes sometimes use the space before noon. A new wall was recently built between the adjoining classrooms. The Principal will look into this tomorrow.

9. Labs

Labs are confirmed for Fridays. Groups attend roughly once a month, with Secondary 3 and 5 on the same day and Secondary 4 on its own day. The Principal will send a schedule of which grade goes when and where.

10. Individual student matters

The students without a manual will receive it today, the Principal has already received the copies and will drop them off. One ELA student will attend a teacher's class twice a week and join the ESL class twice a week, seen twice on Wednesday and twice on Thursday, and the Principal will send his schedule directly. A teacher will lend a personal math book to Salahuddin until his own arrives.

Action items

Action	Owner	Due
Shut the projector off every night	All staff	Ongoing
Check projector settings	Principal	This week
Send links for touchscreen LCD panels	Teacher (Speaker 1)	When available
Send the full week by week plan (portal vs manual)	Principal	This week
Distribute regular workbooks to students	Principal	Today
Collect ELA, French and math manuals from Thursday classes, leave in office	Teachers listed in section 5	Thu 10 Sept, end of day
Return collected manuals to teachers	Principal	Fri 11 Sept, morning
Bring in printer ink	Principal	This week
Send the students-with-difficulties forms and information	Office	This week
Flag students with difficulties	All teachers	25 September
Set up a staff work corner in the side room	Principal	Starting tomorrow
Send lab schedule (grade, day, location)	Principal	To follow
Send the ELA/ESL student's schedule to his teacher	Principal	To follow
Deliver the missing manuals	Principal	Today
Lend math book to Salahuddin pending his copy	Teacher (Speaker 1)	Today
Scanning: group A Monday, group B Tuesday	Teachers	Weekly